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Global Macro Commentary | Global

October 21: Testing the Metals

Sharp sell-offs in gold and silver; Prime Minister Takaichi newly elected in Japan; rumored delays in BoJ hikes; Hungary NBH remains on hold as expected; President Trump suggests he may not meet with Chinese President Xi; strong Canada CPI; DXY at 98.95 (+0.4%); US 10y at 3.964 (-1.7bp).

Japanese rates twist-steepen on political developments while other global rates mostly bull-flatten amid lackluster risk sentiment.

Developed Markets

- **In the Tokyo session, long-end JGBs edge 1bp higher after Takaichi is elected prime minister**, despite reduced political uncertainty typically supporting the long end. With Takaichi's appointment widely expected after the weekend's events, market participants could be seeking to liquidate longer duration risk, taking advantage of the recent rally. Fiscal concerns could be another factor in the long-end underperformance, though our economists [believe](#) investor expectations for large-scale spending are overstated, and that Takaichi's government will focus on implementing policies only in areas of clear agreement between the parties in the newly formed coalition.
- **Front-end JGBs rally after [Bloomberg](#) reports that the BoJ sees "little need to rush" further rate hikes**. 5y JGBs rally 1.5bp as market pricing for an October hike falls another 10% to less than 15%. Our economists still [expect](#) the Takaichi administration to recognize the BoJ's operational independence and avoid direct intervention to delay rate hikes. JPY lags G10 peers (USD/JPY: +0.8%) under pressure from lower front-end yields, the overnight recovery of risk sentiment, and continued uncertainty around the new administration's policies. In particular, traders appear focused on the appointment of Finance Minister Katayama, who has previously [called](#) for a stronger yen and expansionary fiscal policy, but may have shifted her positions over time, in the view of our economists.
- **Gold prices fall more than 5% with no clear catalyst, the largest single-day drop in years**. Silver prices also fall 7%. The move could represent a correction in overstretched technicals for precious metals — as both gold and silver prices were significantly above 50-day moving averages — though supportive factors like rate cuts, inflation, and geopolitical uncertainty remain.
- **Long-end US rates extend Monday's bull-flattening (30y: -3bp) as risk sentiment remains cautious amid mixed signals on US-China trade**. The S&P 500 pares an initial rally to close unchanged after President Trump [says](#)

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he expects "to make a good deal" with Chinese President Xi, but also acknowledges that "maybe" the meeting "won't happen." Meanwhile, the US government shutdown shows little progress as President Trump [urges](#) Senate Republicans not to negotiate, Senate Democrats continue to [vote](#) against funding bills, and the House of Representatives remains on recess.

- **The dollar strengthens against other safe-haven currencies (USD/JPY: +0.8%; USD/CHF: +0.5%; EUR/USD: -0.4%).** CAD leads the G10 (USD/CAD: -0.1%) as front-end Canadian rates sell off 4bp after an upside surprise in September CPI (2.4% y/y; C: 2.2%). In addition, Prime Minister Carney [says](#) the US and Canada could reach a deal on tariffs by next week, though our public policy strategists expect next year's [USMCA review](#) to be the primary catalyst for changes in US-Canada trade policy. Canadian stocks sell off alongside gold and silver given the high exposure of the S&P/TSX (-1.7%) to the Materials sector.
- **European rates bull-flatten (30y Bund: -4bp), with Belgium outperforming the complex in the front end after the Belgian Debt Agency [cancels](#) a future OLO bond auction** "given the progress in long-term funding," making next week the last auction of the year. 30y gilt yields also decline 4bp after UK public sector net borrowing comes slightly below expectations (20.2bn; C: 20.8bn), keeping fiscal concerns in check. In France, however, the 10y OAT-Bund spread widens another 0.5bp. EUR and GBP weaken 0.3-0.4% in line with the dollar's strength.

Emerging Markets

- **In Hungary, rates show little reaction to a widely expected decision by the NBH to keep rates on hold at 6.5%.** Regional currencies underperform, with HUF and PLN both weakening 0.5% against USD and 0.1-0.2% against EUR. After Russia reportedly [rejected](#) the terms of the last week's Ukraine ceasefire proposal, [US](#) and [Russian](#) officials both suggest delays to the previously announced meeting between Presidents Trump and Putin originally set to take place in Hungary, potentially reducing the likelihood of a near-term resolution. Elsewhere in CEEMEA, the South African ZAR weakens 1% against USD as gold sells off.
- **AxJ currencies weaken broadly alongside JPY, with Korea leading regional FX weakness due to its high correlation with JPY.** USD/KRW climbs 0.8% to 1,432 as the US-Korea investment agreement appears unlikely to be finalized before the APEC summit, despite constructive [comments](#) from President Trump. Korean rates extend their recent selloff (NDIRS: +3bp) following a rebound in average daily exports for the first 20 days of October (9.7% y/y; P: -10.6%). In Thailand, THB softens (USD/THB: +0.2%) alongside the sharp decline in gold prices and [reports](#) that the government and BoT are examining factors behind THB's recent strength in excess of its fundamentals. Thai rates sell off (10y ThaiGB: +7bp) after a 25y bond auction [shows](#) weak demand.

- **China diverges from regional peers, with local rates and currencies outperforming.** CNH holds largely stable against USD, supported by a new low in the USD/CNY fixing (7.0930; P: 7.0973) and the overnight supportive [comments](#) from President Trump on reaching a trade deal. Local rates rally (5y CNY NDIRS: -2bp) in a bull-flattening, even as onshore equities (CSI 300) rally another 1.5%.
- **LatAm currencies broadly weaken against the dollar's strength.** In Brazil, BRL weakens 0.3%, and long-end yields fall 3bp despite ongoing fiscal uncertainties. A vote on Brazil's 2026 Budget Guidelines Bill (LDO) is [postponed](#) again, which could add to uncertainty around spending targets. In Chile, CLP also weakens 0.3% against USD amid falling copper prices while local rates sell off 1bp across all tenors. Other LatAm rates like Mexico's TIE and Colombia's IBR curves bull-flatten.

Central Bank Monitor

Developed Markets

- **ECB Chief Economist Lane** [said](#) that monetary policy transmission is progressing smoothly, but "a more powerful monetary intervention" may be needed if uncertainty weakens transmission.
- **BoE MPC Member Mann** [reiterated](#) the stickiness of inflation, and that inflation expectations have drifted from the 2% target.
- **BoE Governor Bailey** and **BoE Deputy Governor Breeden** [confirmed](#) plans to apply stress tests to the private credit market, citing concerns around opacity and leverage.

Emerging Markets

- In **Hungary**, the **NBH** maintained its policy rate at 6.50%, in line with expectations. Although high-frequency data point to weaker 3Q25 GDP growth, the NBH stayed cautious. Our economists still see room for monetary policy easing in December this year and 1Q26, with risks that the NBH may remain on hold. A more cautious NBH should be supportive of HUF. [Read more](#)
- In **South Africa**, **SARB Governor Kganyago** [suggested](#) that officials may use ZAR's strength to boost dollar or euro reserves "if the opportunity avails itself."
- In the **Philippines**, **BSP** [exempted](#) Personal Equity and Retirement Account (PERA) Unit Investment Trust Funds (UITFs) from the non-resident ownership rule, which previously limited their ability to invest in BSP securities if non-residents owned more than 10% of the fund.

Exhibit 1: G4 Rates Closes (5pm NY)

Tenor	US			Germany			UK			Japan		
	21-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	21-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	21-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	21-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
2y	3.455	(0.0)		1.905	(0.1)		3.851	0.2		0.931	(1.2)	
3y	3.458	(0.0)		1.951	(0.7)		3.830	0.0		1.015	(0.6)	
5y	3.564	(0.9)		2.153	(1.4)		3.942	(0.9)		1.221	(1.6)	
7y	3.743	(1.3)		2.291	(1.9)		4.080	(1.9)		1.441	(0.3)	
10y	3.963	(1.7)		2.551	(2.5)		4.477	(2.7)		1.656	(1.0)	
20y	4.516	(2.2)		3.029	(3.3)		5.148	(4.2)		2.632	(0.8)	
30y	4.543	(2.6)		3.127	(3.6)		5.265	(4.4)		3.117	0.2	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Inflation Closes (5pm NY)

US TIPS				10y Real Yields, BEI							
Tenor	21-Oct	1 d Δ (bp)	2wk	10y	21-Oct	1 d Δ (bp)	2wk	10y	21-Oct	1 d Δ (bp)	2wk
5y	1.210	(1.8)		DBRi	0.617	(2.4)		BTPi	1.669	(3.0)	
BEI	2.329	1.2		BEI	1.727	0.4		BEI	1.698	0.6	
10y	1.686	(2.4)		UKTi	1.553	(1.9)					
BEI	2.275	0.7		BEI	2.994	(0.6)					
30y	2.345	(2.5)		JGBi	0.068	0.4					
RFI	2.201	0.1		RFI	1.563	(1.6)					

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 3: Macro Closes (5pm NY)

Spot	Majors			Spot	EM			Index	Equities / Commodities		
	21-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk		21-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk		21-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk
DX	98.93	0.4		CNH	7.13	0.0		S&P	6735.35	0.0	
EUR	1.160	(0.4)		INR	--	--		Stoxx	5686.83	0.1	
GBP	1.337	(0.3)		THB	32.76	0.2		FTSE	9426.99	0.2	
JPY	151.93	0.8		KRW	1432.35	0.8		Nikkei	49316.06	0.3	
CHF	0.796	0.5		ZAR	17.40	1.0		VIX	17.87	(2.0)	
AUD	0.649	(0.4)		MXN	18.44	0.3		Gold (S)	4125.22	(5.3)	
CAD	1.402	(0.1)		BRL	5.39	0.3		WTI (Fut)	57.24	0.4	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 4: G4 Central Bank Implied Pricing

Fed	Implied			ECB	Implied			BOE	Implied			BOJ	Implied		
	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ			1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ			1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ			1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	
EFFR (10/20)	4.110	0.0		EDNIA (10/20)	1.927	0.0		SONIA (10/20)	3.968	0.0		TONAR (10/20)	0.477	0.0	
10/29/25	3.858	0.0	(25.2)	10/30/25	1.922	(0.0)	(0.5)	11/06/25	3.938	0.4	(3.1)	10/30/25	0.483	(6.3)	0.6
12/10/25	3.612	0.2	(49.8)	12/18/25	1.885	(0.2)	(4.2)	12/18/25	3.865	0.7	(10.4)	12/19/25	0.642	0.5	16.5
01/28/26	3.457	(1.0)	(65.3)	02/05/26	1.864	(0.2)	(6.3)	02/05/26	3.731	(0.5)	(23.7)	01/23/26	0.686	(0.0)	20.9
03/18/26	3.326	(0.8)	(78.4)	03/19/26	1.808	0.3	(11.9)	03/19/26	3.682	1.4	(28.6)				
04/29/26	3.250	(0.2)	(86.0)	04/30/26	1.788	0.5	(13.9)	04/30/26	3.586	1.5	(38.2)				
06/17/26	3.110	(0.5)	(100.0)	06/11/26	1.754	(0.5)	(17.3)	06/18/26	3.547	0.9	(42.1)				

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

The Day Ahead*Developed Markets*

- 7:00am BST - **UK Core CPI** (MSe: 3.58% y/y; C: 3.7%; P: 3.6%); **Headline CPI** (MSe: 3.89% y/y; C: 4.0%; P: 3.8%); **Services CPI** (MSe: 4.84% y/y; C: 4.9%; P: 4.7%); **Core Goods CPI** (MSe: 1.50% y/y); **RPI** (MSe: 4.68% y/y; C: 4.8%; P: 4.6%). We expect headline inflation to rise, partly due to base effects in fuel prices and potential ONS methodological choices, though uncertainty remains around the index day.
- 12:00pm BST - **ECB Vice President de Guindos** will speak in Barcelona
- 1:25pm BST - **ECB President Lagarde** will speak in Frankfurt

Emerging Markets

- Wed 3:20pm HKT - **Indonesia BI Rates Decision** (MSe: 4.50%; C: 4.50%; P:

4.75%). We expect a 25bp cut in line with consensus.

- 12:00pm HKT - **Malaysia September CPI** (C: 1.4% y/y; P: 1.3%)
- 7:30am BST - **Hungary September Unemployment Rate** (C: 4.5%; P: 4.4%)
- 9:00am BST - **Poland September Retail Sales** (C: 7.2% y/y; P: 3.0%)
- 9:00am BST - **South Africa September CPI** (MSe: 3.5% y/y; C: 3.4%; P: 3.3%)
- 8:00am EST - **Mexico August Economic Activity IGAE** (P: -1.14% y/y; C: -0.50). Consensus implies a softer contraction versus July, signaling gradual stabilization in activity.

Economic Releases

Developed Markets

- **US October Philadelphia Fed Non-Manufacturing Activity:** -22.2 (P: -12.3). Broad softening in regional activity; firm-level general activity, new orders, and sales/revenues all declined, with the latter two turning negative. Full-time employment also fell. Price pressures eased slightly, though prices paid remained elevated.
- **UK September Public Sector Net Borrowing:** £20.2bn (MSe: £21.0bn; C: £20.8bn; P: £17.962bn). Public sector borrowing came in line with OBR expectations, while cash requirements were below projections
- **Canada September CPI:** 2.4% y/y (C: 2.2%; P: 1.9%); **CPI Ex-Gasoline:** 2.6% y/y (P: 2.4%). Headline CPI accelerated to the fastest pace since February, driven by a smaller decline in gasoline prices. Ex-gasoline CPI reached its highest level since April.

Emerging Markets

- **Korea October First 20 Days Daily Average Exports:** -7.8% y/y (P: 13.5%); **October First 20 Days Imports:** -2.3% y/y (P: 9.9%)
- **Taiwan September Export Orders:** 30.5% y/y (MSe: 19.4%; C: 18.7%; P: 19.5%)

For more details, please refer to our economists' weekly reports and data previews:

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- Hungary Economics and Macro Strategy: [NBH Review - Keeping the Line](#)

- BoJ October MPM Preview: [Watching Whether Governor's Cautious Stance Will Ease Somewhat](#)
- UK Public Finances: [This Looks A Bit Better](#)
- Thoughts on the Market: [How to Navigate US-China Tensions](#)

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Since 2000, enhancements to a G4 10y government bond futures momentum strategy have produced higher Sharpe ratios and stronger returns relative to total return government bond indices for the G4: US, Germany, Japan, and the UK. See [A "Smarter" \(Beta\) Way to Trade G4 10y Futures Duration?](#) for more information on these strategies.

Exhibit 5: Trading Signals for G4 Smarter (beta) Trading Strategy

Current Risk, G4 10y Futures	G4 Strategy Weight	Trade Longs Portfolio	Fade Shorts Portfolio	Total Risk Trade Longs Only	Total Risk Trade Longs/Fade Shorts (max 200%)	Trade Longs Portfolio Entry Date	Trade Longs Portfolio Exit Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Entry Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Exit Date
J8 10y Future	32.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/20/2025	9/19/2025	10/28/2025
GE 10y Future	29.25%	100%	0%	100%	100%	10/7/2025	11/11/2025	-	-
US 10y Future	30.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/14/2025	11/19/2025	9/24/2025	10/30/2025
UK 10y Future	7.75%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/19/2025	9/25/2025	10/30/2025

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Trading Strategy 1 – "Trade Longs/Fade Shorts"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract and hold for a 25-business-day period. In short, this strategy buys futures when the Simple Moving Average Crossover (SMAX) generates both a long and a short signal, given the historical outperformance of long signals traded long and the underperformance of short signals traded short. Given that the SMAX could generate both a long and a short signal within the predefined holding period, an investor may have a 200% long position since each of the two signals would be traded in separate portfolio sleeves.

Trading Strategy 2 – Trade "Longs Only"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, do nothing. In short, an investor *only* trades long signals initiated by the SMAX given their historical precedent to outperform.

US Holiday Trading Strategy

Currently Active Strategies

None.

Combining the individual trading signals based on 10y Treasury future (TY) price patterns before and after US holidays has generated an annual strategy with no down years since 1987. See [Trading 10y Treasury Futures Around US Holidays](#) for more information.

Using historical data since 1983, we created a trading strategy using 10y Treasury futures (TY) that trades 11 times per year, either long or short, before or after the following US holidays: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Day, Presidents' Day, Good Friday, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Columbus Day, Thanksgiving, and Christmas. [Exhibit 6](#) displays the trading rules:

Exhibit 6: Trading rules for US holiday trading model using US 10y futures contracts (TY)

Holiday	Day of Week	Direction	Before/After Holiday	Trading Rule (business days, 3pm NY unless specified)	Trade Entry (business days)	Trade Exit (business days)
New Year's Day	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY New Years +1, Sell TY New Years +4	New Year + 1	New Year + 4
Martin Luther King Day 1	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Tuesday before MLK, Sell Friday before MLK	MLK - 4	MLK - 1
Martin Luther King Day 2	Monday	Short TY	After	Sell TY Tuesday after MLK, Buy Friday after MLK	MLK + 1	MLK + 4
President's Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Pres. Day, Sell TY Friday after Pres. Day	Pres. Day + 1	Pres. Day + 4
Good Friday	Friday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Monday after Good Friday, Sell TY Friday after Good Friday	Good Friday + 1	Good Friday + 5
Memorial Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Mem. Day, Sell TY Friday after Mem. Day	Mem. Day + 1	Mem. Day + 4
Independence Day (July 4th)	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY Independence Day + 2, Sell TY Independence Day + 4	Ind. Day + 2	Ind. Day + 4
Labor Day	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Monday before Labor Day, Sell TY Thursday before Labor Day	Labor Day - 4	Labor Day - 2
Columbus Day	Monday	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Monday before Col. Day, Buy TY Thursday before Col. Day	Colum. Day - 5	Colum. Day - 2
Thanksgiving	Thursday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Friday before Thanksgiving, Sell TY Tuesday before Thanksgiving	Thanksgiving - 4	Thanksgiving - 2
Christmas	Rotates	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Christmas Day - 4, Buy TY Christmas Day - 1	Christmas - 4	Christmas - 1

Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Past performance is no guarantee of future results.

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(as of September 30, 2025)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1499	41%	389	46%	26%	702	41%
Equal-weight/Hold	1618	44%	375	44%	23%	782	45%
Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	1	0%	25%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	577	16%	88	10%	15%	234	14%
Total	3,698		853			1719	

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